

YALE PEABODY MUSEUM

Institutional Data Exit Interview

Version 3 • August 19, 2026

Purpose: This questionnaire is designed to capture institutional knowledge, data assets, systems access, and ongoing responsibilities from departing Yale Peabody Museum staff. It supplements Yale's standard offboarding procedures and is focused on preserving the continuity of collections-related work, programs, digital assets, and operational systems.

Instructions: This form should be completed by the departing employee in collaboration with their supervisor or a designated data manager. Sections are organized by role. Complete the General Information section first, then proceed to the section(s) relevant to your position. Where a question does not apply, write "N/A."

Section 1: General Information

1.1 Departing Employee

Name	
Department / Role	
YPM Email Address	
Personal Email (if willing to be contacted post-departure)	
Phone Number	
Date of Anticipated Departure	
Length of Service at YPM	

1.2 Person Conducting Interview

Name	Gary Motz
Role / Title	Head of Computer Systems
Email Address	gary.motz@yale.edu

Date Form Completed	
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1.3 Designated YPM Point of Contact After Departure

This person will serve as the institutional contact for questions about the departing employee's work, data, and responsibilities.

Name	
Role / Title	
Email Address	

1.4 General Systems & Access

What Yale/YPM systems do you currently have access to that are relevant to your role?

Examples: EMu, LUX, NetX, Preservica, SharePoint, OneDrive, Box@Yale, Google Drive, vendor portals, social media accounts, listservs, etc.

Are there any shared accounts, passwords, or login credentials that need to be transferred?

List system name and current owner. Do not write passwords here—coordinate transfer separately with the Head of Computer Systems.

Are there any automated messages, alerts, or system notifications currently directed to your email that need to be redirected?

Examples: system alerts, vendor notifications, listserv digests, scheduled reports.

Are there any active vendor relationships or service contracts associated with your work?

List vendor name, contract purpose, renewal date, and current point of contact.

Section 2: Collections

Complete this section if your role involved the stewardship, documentation, digitization, or active use of YPM collections in any division (e.g., Invertebrate Paleontology, Invertebrate Zoology, Vertebrate Zoology, Mineralogy & Meteoritics, Anthropology). Questions apply to both Collections Managers and Museum Assistants; items marked “(CM)” are primarily relevant to Collections Manager-level roles.

2.1 Physical Collections & Storage

The physical collections are the primary institutional asset. Ensure all relevant housing, location, and condition information is documented before departure.

Are there any reorganization, rehousing, or relabeling projects currently in progress?

List project name or description, current status, location of affected material, and any associated tracking documents or spreadsheets.

Are there specimens or lots in non-standard or temporary storage locations that may not be evident from EMu records alone?

List object group, temporary location, reason for placement, and estimated quantity.

Are there any known pest, mold, or contamination concerns in the collections currently under your care?

List affected objects or area, nature of concern, current treatment status, and who else is aware. Note the location of any pest monitoring logs.

Are there specimens flagged for conservation treatment or rehousing that have not yet been addressed?

List taxon or lot identifiers, nature of concern, priority level, and location.

2.2 EMu Catalog Records & Data Quality

EMu is YPM's primary collections management system. Any data entry work, custom configurations, or known data quality issues should be documented here.

Are there active data entry backlogs, incomplete catalog records, or known data quality issues in EMu that should be flagged for your successor?

Describe the nature of the issue, estimated scope (number of records), and whether any tracking spreadsheet or work queue exists.

Have you created or maintained any custom EMu reports, saved searches, or data entry templates that are used regularly in your division?

List report or template name, purpose, and where documentation exists. Note any that are shared across staff versus specific to your login.

Are there any data entry projects or catalog cleanup efforts underway that are being tracked outside of EMu (e.g., in spreadsheets or shared documents)?

List project name, location of tracking file, current status, and suggested handoff contact.

Are there records in EMu that require follow-up action (e.g., records flagged as "in progress," unverified identifications, or records awaiting locality data)?

Describe the category of issue, how records are identified in EMu, and recommended next steps.

2.3 Loans

Active loans represent legal agreements and fiduciary responsibility. All outstanding loan activity must be clearly documented and transitioned before departure.

List all active outgoing loans for which you are the primary contact or responsible staff member.

For each loan: borrower name and institution, YPM loan number, specimens included (taxon/lot range), loan start date, agreed return date, and current status. Note any loans that are overdue or for which return communication is outstanding.

Are there any outgoing loans for which there are known conservation concerns, damage reports, or unresolved condition issues?

Describe the concern, loan number, and any prior correspondence or documentation.

List all active incoming loans currently housed at YPM for which you are the primary contact.

For each: lending institution, loan number, taxon/material, agreed return date, and storage location within YPM.

Are there any pending loan requests (outgoing or incoming) that have not yet been processed or approved?

List requestor, material requested, current stage of processing, and location of any associated correspondence.

Where is loan-related correspondence, paperwork, and documentation stored?

Note whether loan records are maintained only in EMu, in physical files, in email, or in a combination. Identify the location of any physical loan folders.

|2.4 Acquisitions, Donations & Uncatalogued Material

Is there any recently acquired or donated material that has not yet been fully accessioned, cataloged, or integrated into the collection?

List donor name (if applicable), acquisition date, approximate quantity, taxon group, current physical location, and stage of processing (e.g., received, sorted, partially cataloged).

Are there any pending acquisition discussions, conditional donations, or deaccession actions currently in progress?

Describe the nature of the transaction, parties involved, and current status. Note location of any associated documentation or correspondence.

Is there material from field collecting trips that remains unprocessed or only partially integrated into the collection?

List collecting trip (location/date), material type, current physical location, and processing status. Note location of any associated field notes, photographs, or locality data.

|2.5 Digitization Projects

What digitization projects are currently active or in progress within your division?

For each project: project name or description, grant or funding source (if applicable), scope (taxon group, estimated lot/specimen count), current completion status, and where project tracking documents are stored.

Where are digitization-related files stored, including specimen images, transcription outputs, and associated metadata?

List storage location (e.g., NetX, shared drive, local workstation), folder structure, and naming conventions. Note any files not yet transferred to shared institutional storage.

Are there imaging workflows, SOPs, or equipment configurations specific to your division that are not currently documented?

Describe the workflow and note whether documentation can be prepared before departure.

Are there georeferencing projects or locality data enhancement efforts currently in progress?

List taxon group or project scope, tool or platform used (e.g., GeoLocate, Georeferencing Calculator), current status, and where outputs or tracking files are stored.

2.6 Facilities, Equipment & Supplies

What equipment is under your direct care or assigned to your division?

Examples: microscopes, imaging stations, freezers, cryogenic storage units, prep tools, balances, desiccators. For each: equipment name/model, location, operational status, and maintenance or calibration schedule.

Are there hazardous materials, controlled substances, or regulated chemicals associated with your collections work?

Examples: ethanol stocks, formalin, arsenic-treated specimens, mercury-treated historical materials. List material, quantity, storage location, safety documentation, and whether a transfer or disposal protocol is in place.

Are there consumable supplies (e.g., vials, jars, trays, labels, ethanol) that need to be inventoried, reordered, or transferred?

List item, current quantity, supplier, and location of ordering information or accounts.

2.7 Regulatory & Compliance (CM)

Items in this sub-section are primarily relevant to Collections Manager-level roles. Museum Assistants should consult their supervisor.

Are there active CITES permits, import/export licenses, or federal/state collecting permits associated with collections in your care?

List permit type, permit number, issuing authority, expiration date, and where permit documents are stored.

Are there any ongoing compliance obligations, reporting deadlines, or renewal processes that need to be handed off?

Describe the obligation, next action required, deadline, and where associated documentation is stored.

Are there any collections with specific legal, repatriation, or deaccession obligations (e.g., NAGPRA, collections under institutional review)?

Describe the situation, current status, relevant documentation location, and who else is involved.

|2.8 Budget & Grants (CM)

Items in this sub-section are primarily relevant to Collections Manager-level roles.

What budget accounts or cost centers are you currently responsible for managing?

List account name/number, funding source, current balance, and Yale Workday or grants contact.

Are there active grants for which you serve as Principal Investigator or key personnel?

List grant title, funding agency, grant number, project period, current status, and any upcoming reporting deadlines.

Are there pending grant proposals or funding applications currently in preparation?

List funder, proposal title, submission deadline, and co-investigators or collaborators involved.

Are there active purchasing relationships, vendor accounts, or supply orders associated with your division budget?

List vendor, purpose, account contact, and where ordering history or agreements are stored.

2.9 Research & Publications

Are there any collections-based research projects or manuscripts currently in preparation or under review for which YPM collections data or specimens are central?

List project title, collaborators, current status, and where associated files and data are stored.

Are there any type specimens, figured specimens, or voucher specimens cited in publications or manuscripts in progress that need to be flagged in EMu?

List catalog numbers and associated publication or manuscript if known.

Section 3: Student Programs

Complete this section if your role involved managing, coordinating, or supporting student engagement, internships, fellowships, or educational programming at YPM.

3.1 Program Overview & Documentation

What student programs, internships, or fellowships are you currently managing or have managed?

List program name, affiliated Yale school or department, active/inactive status, and current student count.

Where are the program materials (curricula, syllabi, project briefs, evaluation rubrics) stored?

Include file path or location (e.g., SharePoint folder, shared drive, Box@Yale). List file names where helpful.

Are there active MOUs, agreements, or formal partnerships with Yale schools, departments, or external organizations?

List partners, agreement expiration dates, and where documents are stored.

Are there any pending or upcoming recruitment cycles, program deadlines, or student commitments that need immediate attention?

Include dates and responsible parties.

3.2 Student Records & Contacts

Note: Student records may be subject to FERPA. Coordinate with YPM's Records Management or the Yale Registrar's Office as needed.

Where are current and past student contact lists, onboarding materials, or program rosters stored?

Confirm these are stored on an institutional system (e.g. EMu, and not personal drives or email).

Are there currently active students whose projects, placements, or mentorship arrangements need to be transitioned?

List names, project status, and suggested handoff contacts.

Are there student field notebooks, project reports, or portfolio materials that should be transferred to YPM institutional storage?

List location and format (physical or digital).

|3.3 Digital Platforms & Communication

What digital platforms or tools were used to communicate with students or manage program activities?

Examples: Canvas, Yale Connect, Handshake, Slack, Teams, shared email aliases.

Are there any social media accounts, listservs, or mailing lists associated with student programming that you manage?

List platform, account name/handle, and where login credentials are stored.

Section 4: Graphic Design

Complete this section if your role involved graphic design, visual communications, brand assets, or print/digital production for YPM.

|4.1 Design Files & Asset Libraries

Where are your working design files stored?

Include location (e.g., NetX, SharePoint, local drive), folder structure, and naming conventions. Note any files stored locally that have not been backed up to a shared platform.

Where are finalized/production-ready assets stored (logos, brand elements, exhibit graphics, templates)?

Distinguish between source files (e.g., .ai, .psd, .indd) and export-ready files (.pdf, .png, .jpg).

Are there any active or in-progress design projects that need to be transferred or completed?

List project name, current status, relevant files, and suggested handoff contact.

4.2 Brand Standards & Templates

Where are YPM brand guidelines, style guides, or institutional templates stored?

List file names and locations. Note any YPM-specific guidelines that differ from Yale University brand standards.

Are there custom fonts, color palettes, or other brand assets that are stored locally and need to be transferred to shared storage?

List asset name, format, and location.

4.3 Software Licenses

What design software do you use, and how are licenses managed?

Examples: Adobe Creative Cloud (individual or shared license?), Canva, Figma, InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop.
List software name, license type, license owner, and renewal date.

Are there any font licenses, stock image subscriptions, or plugin licenses that need to be transferred or renewed?

List vendor, license terms, expiration, and whether usage rights apply to YPM as an institution.

Are there any subscriptions for stock photography, icon libraries, or other licensed visual content currently in use?

List subscription name, login location, renewal date, and billing information.

|4.4 Print Vendor Relationships

Are there active print vendor accounts or relationships used for YPM exhibit or communications materials?

List vendor name, account contact, and where specifications or past order files are stored.

Section 5: 3D Scanning & Printing

Complete this section if your role involved 3D scanning of collections objects, 3D printing for exhibit fabrication or public engagement, or related workflows and equipment.

|5.1 Equipment

What 3D scanning and printing equipment is under your care or responsibility?

For each item: equipment name/model, location (room/lab), serial number if available, and current operational status.

Are there maintenance schedules, calibration logs, or service contracts associated with this equipment?

List where these records are stored and when the next scheduled maintenance is due.

Are there consumable materials (filament, resins, calibration tools) that need to be inventoried or transferred?

List material type, current quantity, supplier, and storage location.

5.2 Scan & Print Files

Where are 3D scan files stored, and how are they organized?

Include storage location, naming convention, and any associated metadata (e.g., YPM catalog number, date scanned, scanner used). Note files stored locally that have not yet been transferred to shared/archival storage.

Where are 3D print files (.stl, .obj, .3mf, etc.) and associated slicing profiles stored?

Note which files are final/production-ready versus in-progress.

Are there any ongoing scanning or printing projects that need to be transitioned?

List project name, associated YPM collection/exhibit, status, and suggested handoff contact.

Are there scan files that have been published or shared externally (e.g., MorphoSource, Sketchfab, Thingiverse)?

List platform, asset URL, YPM catalog number, and access/licensing terms.

5.3 Software & Workflows

What software is used for 3D scanning, post-processing, or printing?

Examples: Agisoft Metashape, RealityCapture, ZBrush, Meshmixer, Cura, PrusaSlicer. For each: license type, license holder, renewal date, and where the license key or login is stored.

Is there documented workflow guidance (e.g., SOPs, README files, or guides) for the scanning and printing processes?

List document name, location, and date last updated.

Section 6: Exhibit Interactive Kiosks

Complete this section if your role involved designing, building, maintaining, or managing hardware and software for interactive exhibit kiosks or digital display installations at YPM.

6.1 Kiosk Inventory

Provide an inventory of all interactive kiosks or digital display units under your responsibility.

For each unit: location (gallery/room), hardware specs, operating system, current exhibit association, and operational status.

Are there kiosks or systems that are currently offline, in storage, or pending decommission?

List unit, location, reason for current status, and any pending action items.

6.2 Software & Content

What software platforms or CMS tools are used to manage kiosk content?

Examples: custom applications, Unity, Kioware, Scala, proprietary vendor platforms. List software name, version, license holder, and where login credentials are stored.

Where are kiosk content files stored (videos, images, interactive assets, application code)?

List storage location, folder structure, and naming conventions. Confirm that all production content is backed up to an institutional system.

Are there any kiosks built or maintained by external vendors? If so, what access or documentation exists?

List vendor name, vendor contact, nature of the build, and where contracts or documentation are stored. Note any security review status with Yale's Information Security Office.

Are there any kiosk systems that have been flagged for security concerns, technical debt, or required remediation?

Describe the issue, current status, and any ongoing coordination with Yale Information Security or IT.

|6.3 Hardware Maintenance & Access

Are there special access requirements to maintain or service kiosk hardware?

Examples: physical keys, admin passwords, dongles, VPN access, remote management tools. Coordinate transfer of credentials with IT.

Where are hardware maintenance logs, troubleshooting guides, or warranty documents stored?

List document name, location, and date last updated.

Are there scheduled maintenance tasks, content refresh cycles, or upcoming exhibit changes that need immediate attention?

List task, due date, and responsible parties.

Section 7: Volunteer Coordination

Complete this section if your role involved recruiting, training, scheduling, managing, or communicating with YPM volunteers.

7.1 Volunteer Database & Records

Note: Volunteer contact information is personal data and should be stored on institutional systems only. Confirm no volunteer records reside on personal devices or personal cloud storage.

Where is the volunteer database or roster stored, and what system or platform manages it?

Examples: Volgistics, Better Impact, spreadsheet on SharePoint, EMu, or a custom system. List system name, access instructions, and who else currently has admin access.

Are volunteer records current and complete? Are there any data quality issues that should be flagged?

Note any volunteers with incomplete records, expired background checks, or lapsed status.

Where are volunteer program documents stored (handbooks, onboarding packets, agreements, background check records)?

List file names and storage locations.

7.2 Scheduling & Active Commitments

What scheduling tool or process is used to manage volunteer shifts?

List platform or method, where the schedule is stored, and who has editing access.

Are there active volunteer commitments, upcoming scheduled shifts, or recurring programs that require immediate handoff?

List program name, frequency, upcoming dates, and key volunteer contacts.

Are there volunteers in specialized roles (e.g., docents, collections assistants, event support) with ongoing responsibilities?

List role, volunteer name(s), and nature of commitment.

|7.3 Training & Recognition

Where are volunteer training materials stored?

Include orientation guides, gallery scripts, safety training, collections handling protocols, etc. List file locations.

Are there any recognition programs, awards, or milestones (e.g., anniversary acknowledgments) that need to be maintained?

List program name, schedule, and where tracking information is stored.

|7.4 Communication Channels

How do you currently communicate with volunteers (newsletters, email lists, platform messaging)?

List platform, mailing list address, admin login location, and subscriber count if known.

Are there any external partnerships with community organizations, schools, or volunteer placement agencies?

List organization name, contact person, nature of the partnership, and any formal agreements.

Section 8: Shared Data Considerations (All Roles)

The questions below apply to all departing staff, regardless of role.

8.1 Data Storage & Backup

Are there any data, files, or assets currently stored only on personal devices, personal cloud accounts, or local drives?

Identify what needs to be transferred to institutional storage before departure.

Are there any proprietary scripts, macros, or automated workflows that you have developed for YPM work?

List tool name, purpose, programming language, location, and whether documentation exists.

8.2 Copyright, Privacy & Sensitive Data

Do any of your data, files, or assets involve licensing restrictions, third-party copyrights, or proprietary content?

List item, rights holder, license terms, and expiration date if applicable.

Do you hold or have access to any data considered sensitive, restricted, or personally identifiable (PII)?

If yes, confirm that appropriate transfer or deletion protocols have been followed and note any outstanding actions.

8.3 Continuity & Knowledge Transfer

Are there any processes, workflows, or institutional knowledge that is not currently documented and should be before your departure?

List topic and whether you are able to prepare a brief written summary.

Do you plan to continue any work with YPM after departure (e.g., emeritus, affiliate, consulting, publication)?

If yes, describe the nature of continued engagement and what data or system access would be needed.

Is there anything else the museum should know to ensure continuity of your work after you depart?

Section 9: Offboarding Checklist

Use this checklist to confirm that key offboarding steps have been completed. Check each item when done.

9.1 Data & Files

- ☐ All work files transferred from personal devices or personal cloud storage to YPM/Yale institutional systems
- ☐ Design assets and source files archived to NetX or designated shared storage
- ☐ 3D scan and print files backed up to shared institutional storage with correct metadata
- ☐ Kiosk content files confirmed in institutional storage; no production content stored only locally
- ☐ Student program materials transferred to shared drive and point of contact notified
- ☐ Volunteer records confirmed as stored on institutional system only
- ☐ Personal email folders reviewed; relevant institutional correspondence archived or forwarded

9.2 Systems & Access

- ☐ Shared account credentials transferred to designated colleague and confirmed with IT
- ☐ Software license ownership transferred or documented for IT/Finance to manage renewal
- ☐ Vendor portals and third-party accounts updated with new institutional contact
- ☐ Automated notifications and system alerts redirected to active email address
- ☐ Kiosk admin access documented and transferred
- ☐ Volunteer platform admin access transferred
- ☐ Yale NetID and system access termination coordinated with Yale IT

9.3 Knowledge Transfer

- ☐ Undocumented processes summarized in written handoff notes
- ☐ Active student, intern, or volunteer commitments communicated to successor or supervisor
- ☐ Vendor relationships and key contacts briefed to successor
- ☐ Outstanding projects documented with current status and next steps
- ☐ Exit interview form reviewed and signed off by both departing employee and data manager

Signatures

Departing Employee

Signature:

Print Name:

Date:

Interviewer / Manager

Signature:

Print Name:

Date: